History

- Louis Pasteur was an extremely successful scientist, making many revolutionary discoveries in many fields of science, but was personally a chemist, despite most of his work being done in biology.
- At the time of his work, scientists believed disease was caused by miasma and that microbes were caused due to Spontaneous Generation, with the microscope being very recently discovered (discovered in the eighteenth century) and the theory of evolution being published in Charles Darwin's *On the Origin of Species* the same year that Pasteur proposed Germ Theory.
- industrialization, making his work on vaccines and germ theory highly practical and useful at the time.
- With the increase in population, there were many more disease outbreaks that his work greatly helped in reducing.